

TOPIC 3: POSTURAL DEFECTS

1. Meaning of Postural Defects

Postural defects are abnormal or incorrect alignments of the body that develop from poor habits, weakness, injury or disease. They can cause pain, fatigue and reduced efficiency of movement.

2. Common Types of Postural Defects

- **Kyphosis** – excessive outward curve of the upper back (round back / hunchback)
- **Lordosis** – excessive inward curve of the lower back (sway back)
- **Scoliosis** – sideways (lateral) curve of the spine
- **Flat feet** – arches of the feet are flattened
- **Knock knees** and **bow legs**
- Forward head posture and rounded shoulders (common with prolonged phone/computer use)

3. Causes

Poor sitting/standing habits, weak core or back muscles, carrying heavy loads on one side, injury, congenital factors, and lack of physical activity.

4. Prevention and Correction

Maintain good posture, strengthen core and back muscles, stretch regularly, use proper furniture and footwear, seek early medical or physiotherapy advice when a defect is noticed.

5. Summary

Postural defects such as kyphosis, lordosis and scoliosis can be reduced by good habits, exercise and early attention. Awareness and prevention are better than correction later.

End of Topic 3